

Inna Popova - Project Coordinator

CONTACT

Inna Popova

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- Auckland, New Zealand
- New Zealand Permanent Resident

SUMMARY

- Operations and business support professional currently working in a New Zealand AI technology environment, supporting delivery teams with documentation, coordination, and clear communication.
- Programme coordination background with experience keeping schedules, resources, and stakeholders aligned across fast-moving and scaling organisations.
- Strong stakeholder communication across internal teams, suppliers, contractors, and service providers, with a consistent focus on practical follow-through.
- Experienced in maintaining accurate documentation and structured reporting, including records and compliance-related registers.
- Comfortable managing competing priorities while supporting service delivery continuity and timely issue resolution.
- Hands-on with Microsoft Office, Google Workspace, Slack, and Jira in day-to-day operational and project support work.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Mindhive Limited / Mindhive Global - Operations & Business Support Coordinator

Jan 2025 - Present · contract · AI technology, machine vision, industrial quality systems

New Zealand technology company developing AI-powered machine vision systems for industrial quality assessment, defect detection, and grading.

Highlights

- Provide day-to-day operational, administrative, and coordination support across office operations, procurement, finance administration, facilities, and internal business support functions.
- Coordinate purchasing activities including supplier communication, quote collection, purchase order preparation, invoice follow-up, and delivery tracking.
- Support procurement and inventory control through hardware sourcing support, stock checks, supplier follow-up, and documentation improvements.
- Liaise with internal teams, external suppliers, contractors, and service providers to support smooth workflows and timely resolution of operational issues.

- Support finance administration through invoice management, purchase order coordination, quote tracking, and use of Xero and Dext.
- Contribute to improving internal systems, documentation, and operational processes in a fast-moving technology environment.

Tech: Jira, Microsoft Office, Google Workspace, Slack, Xero, Dext, AI-assisted tools

Marie International School - Operations & Programme Coordination Lead / Head Administrator

Jan 2021 - Dec 2024 · full-time · International education, early childhood education

International school in Nishinomiya, Japan, experiencing rapid growth across multiple campuses with a threefold increase in enrolment and team size.

Highlights

- Started as an Administrator and progressed to Assistant Teacher for 3-5-year-olds, and ultimately became the Head Teacher at a newly established school.
- Successfully managed the administration amidst resource shortages, doubling student enrollment in the first year.
- Created a positive work culture among staff members, contributing to the school's reputation as a desirable educational institution through word-of-mouth referrals.
- Coordinated daily operations across 3+ functional areas, supporting consistent service delivery for 100+ students and families during rapid growth.
- Managed scheduling and workflow coordination for 20+ staff members, strengthening alignment and communication across campuses.
- Maintained and streamlined 30+ operational documents, records, and compliance registers, improving process clarity and administrative consistency.
- Acted as primary liaison between leadership, staff, parents, partners, and suppliers, handling 50+ weekly enquiries with structured and timely communication.
- Coordinated 10+ cross-campus programmes, events, and initiatives from planning through execution, including large-scale events involving 150+ attendees and 20+ staff.
- Supported onboarding and integration of new team members during rapid expansion, reinforcing scalable processes and service consistency.
- Management and creation of school documentation, uniform, lunch orders, and disaster drills.
- Stock management of materials and needed items, and building management.
- Communication with parents, leading school tours, and managing social media platforms such as Instagram, ClassDojo, and the school's website.
- Creating surveys for different occasions and improvements in school flow.
- Leading Afterschool programs for kindergarten and primary students.
- Decoration and organizing of the building, and creating events from scratch including venue selection, scripting, organization, and hosting.
- Designing advertisements for banners, websites, and flyers.
- Advising on the school improvement process and communicating with the head office.
- Organized and executed various school events from inception to completion, ensuring seamless coordination and a memorable experience for all participants.

Tech: Microsoft Office, ClassDojo, Instagram

Independent Client Services & Programme Coordination - Self-Employed

Jan 2012 - Dec 2020 · contract · Tourism, hospitality, client services

Demand-driven independent service business operating within a competitive and highly seasonal market in Japan, including tourist guiding across Kyoto and Nara (2015-2020) and bespoke client programme delivery for international B2C and B2B clients.

Highlights

- Designed and delivered customised client programmes for international B2C and B2B clients, managing full service lifecycle coordination.
- Managed seasonal revenue planning, expense tracking, and invoicing, maintaining financial oversight and supplier cost control.
- Coordinated 5-10 external vendor bookings per programme, ensuring seamless multi-provider execution.
- Analysed demand trends and adjusted service offerings based on seasonal patterns and operational capacity.
- Built referral networks and independent marketing channels, generating repeat and word-of-mouth business.
- Worked as a Tourist Guide in Kyoto and Nara, Japan, for USA and New Zealand groups and individual tourists (2015-2020).

Translation & Content Operations Support - Freelance Translator

Jan 2008 - Dec 2012 · contract · Translation, content operations

Freelance translation and content localisation services for service-based and education-focused organisations.

Highlights

- Managed multiple concurrent client projects involving documentation coordination and marketing content localisation (English-Russian).
- Ensured deadline adherence, quality control, and alignment with client communication standards.
- Supported operational and promotional documentation for service-based and education-focused organisations.

Takapuna Primary School - After School Care Assistant

Jan 2011 - Dec 2014 · part-time · Primary education, after-school care

Auckland primary school providing after-school care for students.

Career Break - Parental Leave

Jan 2006 - Dec 2009 · career-break · N/A

Planned family leave period before re-entering client-facing service and operations roles.

Spartak Tour Ltd. - Outbound Tourism Manager

Jan 2003 - Dec 2006 · full-time · Outbound tourism, travel

Travel company in Khabarovsk, Russia, specialising in outbound international travel packages, primarily Asian destinations.

EDUCATION

- **Specialist Degree in Management (Socio-Cultural Services & Tourism)** - Pacific State University (Pacific National University), Khabarovsk, Russia (1998-2003)